Grace Gormley

Data journalist

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Education

Northwestern University, Medill School of Journalism — Evanston, IL · Expected June 2028

- B.S., Journalism and B.A. Data Science (double major) · GPA 3.97/4.0 · Dean's List 6/6 quarters
- Relevant coursework: Advanced Machine Learning, Investigative Narratives, Statistical Theory and Methods, Information Management for Data Science, Court Watchers: The Legal Beat
- Palo Alto High School, 2024 · National Merit Scholar · Editor-in-Chief, *Viking Sports Magazine*

Data and Investigative Projects

Digital Exhibit: Government Environmental Surveys · Northwestern Knight Lab Studio Team Project - Python, OCR, BERTopic, LLMs, GitHub Pages · Jan 2026-March 2026 · link

- Extracted structured metadata (including summaries, key collaborators and locational data) and used LLMs to read documents at scale, turning an unstructured archive into a queryable dataset
- Applied BERTopic topic modeling to surface recurring themes across the collection, built and published the prototype exhibit as a GitHub Pages site
- Continued the project as a paid researcher; see Experience

Can Chicago's Worst Police Misconduct Cases Be Handled Behind Closed Doors? · Court Watchers: The Legal Beat (Medill), team project · June 2026 · link

- Investigated a pending Illinois Supreme Court appeal over whether arbitration hearings in Chicago police termination cases can be closed to the public, affecting at least 21 pending cases, seven involving alleged unjustified shootings
- Conducted 6 of the story's 8 interviews, including one survivor of Burge-era torture and another man who served 16 years on death row following a wrongful conviction; analyzed trial and appellate court filings
- Built the story's interactive timeline with Claude Code and fact-checked every entry against court records and reporting

Experience

Embarcadero Media Foundation — Bay Area, CA *Summer 2025 full time internship, ongoing freelance work* May 2025–Present

- Reported for Palo Alto Weekly, Mountain View Voice, The Almanac
- Published stories on local government, infrastructure and community figures, on deadline
- Pitched and wrote stories beyond assignments; shot my own photos; copyedited print editions

Northwestern Knight Lab — Evanston, IL · *Summer 2026 full time internship, ongoing part time work* May 2026–Present

- Engineered a pipeline for extracting reliable metadata from thousands of documents using LLMs
- Apply distant reading, data visualization and accessible-design methods to make archives searchable

The Daily Northwestern — Evanston, IL — *Reporter* Sept 2025–Present

- Built an original dataset of 31 guest performances linking 15 student dance groups across 6 campus shows (Nov. 2024–Apr. 2025); visualized it as a Flourish network graph for a feature on the dance community

Northwestern School of Education and Social Policy — Evanston, IL · *Student News Writer* June 2024–Present

- Write features and profiles covering faculty, students, research and campus life for the alumni magazine and website

Stand Up, Speak Out Journalism Camp — Palo Alto, CA · *Founder and Director* Nov 2022–Sept 2023

- Founded a free journalism camp for 70+ underserved middle schoolers; each published an article in a printed magazine
- Built a feeder program into Palo Alto High's journalism program and recruited a successor who sustained it

Skills & Activities

- **Data:** Python (pandas, matplotlib, scikit-learn), SQL, R, PyTorch, XGBoost, Keras
- **Visualization:** Flourish, Datawrapper, native Python tools
- **Reporting:** public records research, interviewing, copy editing, photography, video production (Adobe Creative Suite)
- **Languages:** Spanish (fluent)
- **Leadership:** Peer Adviser; Medill representative at JEA/NSPA national conference (2025, 2026); Camp Kesem counselor, Northwestern Tour Guide